



Notes

Apr 24, 2026

Panasonic Aero - AAP - Follow up

Invited [Richard Lavin](#) rodrigo.magana@panasonic.aero justin.rue@panasonic.aero [Jason Anderson](#) matthew.white@panasonic.aero mauricio.dagraca@panasonic.aero [Raed Soliman](#) [Bill Venella](#) christine.chung@panasonic.aero [Ramzi Husein](#) [Devin Parrish](#) [John Lorenz](#)

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Summary

The team aligned on integrating Event Driven Ansible with Netbox via webhooks to accelerate network automation.

Current Automation and Inventory

The team leverages Ansible Automation Platform with Netbox as the source of truth for global infrastructure. They are currently prioritizing DNS and Big IP device automation via modular playbooks.

Event Driven Integration Strategy

Integrating Event Driven Ansible with Netbox webhooks will automate configuration changes and device provisioning. This approach utilizes rulebooks to listen for events and trigger specific workflows in the platform.

Scalability and Future Planning

The team will refactor existing playbooks to use certified modules and Git

for configuration as code. They aim to demonstrate value to justify increased licensing for future managed services.

Next steps

[Ramzi Husein] Investigate Integration: Review integration options (AAP vs. direct) for linking VMware and Netbox; determine optimal method for configuration sync.

[Ramzi Husein] Research Inventory: Look into solutions for the constructed inventory issue where hosts appear multiple times or show duplication in AAP.

[John Lorenz] Involve Team: Pull in team members Mandar, Stewart, and others to participate in automation group discussions.

[Justin Rue] Schedule Lab: Provide Jason or Ramzi with available times to set up the Netbox and Event-Driven Automation lab environment.

[Jason Anderson] Follow Up: Contact Justin next week regarding ideas and thoughts for subsequent conversations.

Details

- **Introductions and Automation Environment Overview:** Jason Anderson initiated the meeting by introducing Ramzi Husein, an Ansible solution architect, to the team, and requested an overview of the current environment. Justin Rue then provided context, stating that the team is focused on network automation, particularly for their global F5 load balancer infrastructure, which includes both physical and virtual devices. They have been utilizing the Ansible Automation Platform (AAP) for this work.
- **Current Network Automation Initiatives:** The team is working to expedite new service delivery, with DNS being one of the services targeted for automation. While the DNS deployment playbooks are not as streamlined as desired, they are moving toward smaller, modular playbooks instead of one large one, and are leveraging workflow job templates to combine processes ([00:01:17](#)).
- **Dynamic Inventory and Configuration Management:** They currently have dynamic inventory pulled from various sources, most recently Netbox, which is intended to serve as their Configuration Management Database (CMDB) ([00:01:17](#)). The team is actively working on dynamic grouping within the Netbox

inventory for smart inventories, which is specifically intended for their Big IP infrastructure to clarify where these devices reside. They also have templates for provisioning, getting device information (such as failover state), and handling registration information for their Big IP infrastructure ([00:02:44](#)).

- **Future Integration Plans:** Future plans include leveraging dynamic inventory for their Linux operations checks and addressing custom in-house applications that need automation ([00:02:44](#)). The team is actively seeking integration with ServiceNow and Event-Driven Ansible (EDA), noting that the barrier to entry for these integrations has reportedly decreased. They have also deployed custom execution environments tailored for specific collections, such as those for Netbox and Big IP ([00:04:08](#)).
- **Network Device Scope and Inventory Sources:** Ramzi Husein inquired about the types of networking devices being automated besides the F5 Big IP infrastructure. Justin Rue confirmed they have a variety of Cisco and Juniper equipment, along with Linux and some Windows systems, and they are pulling many of these devices from Netbox, though they are not currently focused on automating all of their Netbox-sourced infrastructure ([00:04:08](#)). They are currently prioritizing domain-specific infrastructure, such as F5 and DNS, as shared services ([00:05:15](#)).
- **Next Steps for Automation and EDA Implementation:** Ramzi Husein suggested the next step should be implementing EDA and integrating it with Netbox so that device additions or configuration changes automatically trigger jobs in AAP. Justin Rue confirmed they have existing job templates for Cisco and Juniper devices, developed by colleagues, which they plan to migrate from a single-node lab instance to their multi-node containerized environment using APIs ([00:06:28](#)).
- **ServiceNow Integration Status:** Justin Rue confirmed that ServiceNow integration is a high-priority item on their roadmap, explaining they are working with their corporate IT department to secure the necessary token for the integration. Ramzi Husein then offered to share a Netbox lab environment to demonstrate the integrations ([00:07:38](#)).
- **Implementing EDA with Netbox Webhooks:** Ramzi Husein outlined the process for integrating Netbox with AAP using EDA and webhooks, since there is no custom EDA source specifically for Netbox. The approach involves setting up a web hook from Netbox to AAP and using a rulebook that listens for events coming in from Netbox ([00:08:56](#)) ([00:10:54](#)). Justin Rue acknowledged the need for guidance in the EDA area, despite some prior discussion on the topic ([00:09:57](#)).
- **Rulebook Functionality and Event-Driven Automation Demo:** Ramzi Husein explained that a rulebook activation runs in the background, listening for events on a specific port, and uses rules to look for conditions within the incoming payloads to trigger specific actions, such as running a job or workflow template ([00:10:54](#)). They demonstrated this by updating an NTP config context in Netbox,

which immediately triggered a job run in AAP to apply the new configuration ([00:12:56](#)). They also showed how adding a new device in Netbox triggered a "provision new device" workflow in AAP ([00:14:47](#)).

- **Data Parity between VMware and Netbox:** Justin Rue raised the issue of maintaining data parity, questioning how Netbox knows the dynamic state of devices in VMware and whether Ansible can push this information to Netbox. Ramzi Husein clarified that Netbox is considered the source of truth in their current examples, but agreed that AAP could be used to push inventory data from VMware to Netbox using the Netbox Ansible collection ([00:16:13](#)) ([00:18:39](#)). Ramzi Husein committed to looking into whether it makes more sense for AAP to update the CMDB or to integrate Netbox and VMware directly ([00:20:47](#)).
- **VMware Ansible Content and Certified Collections:** Ramzi Husein highlighted that the VMware integration is well-developed, demonstrating a comprehensive, certified collection with 134 modules. Justin Rue noted that their team has been working to use smaller playbooks to stick close to module documentation to someday claim certified code ([00:21:43](#)). Ramzi Husein reinforced the value of using certified content for support ([00:22:33](#)).
- **Automating Processes with Certified Modules:** Ramzi Husein explained that automation starts by drafting the current manual steps and mapping them one-to-one with the available certified modules. John Lorenz emphasized the need for better project planning and task alignment to ensure the completion of automation work ([00:24:44](#)). Ramzi Husein agreed that breaking down work into smaller, manageable tasks, such as integrating Netbox with EDA, will help show value ([00:25:55](#)).
- **Lab Environment and Procedure Documentation:** John Lorenz requested documentation or procedures for the steps demonstrated to ensure team members can follow the necessary processes ([00:25:55](#)). Ramzi Husein offered to spin up the demonstrated Netbox lab environment for the team for a limited time, which includes all the necessary instructions and access to public repositories containing the playbooks and rulebooks used ([00:26:58](#)).
- **Leveraging Git for Configuration as Code:** Justin Rue inquired about using Git (specifically GitLab) as a source of truth, where they use Ansible to generate DNS configuration templates and pull in group variables, questioning how AAP uses this information. Ramzi Husein confirmed that Git is considered a source of truth for configuration and detailed that AAP uses the Netbox web hook and event rules to pull configuration data, along with specific custom fields for AAP connectivity, like the SSH port ([00:29:33](#)) ([00:31:31](#)).
- **Configuration Variable Management in AAP:** Ramzi Husein proposed that the team could utilize configuration as code in GitLab with group variables, allowing Ansible playbooks to pull configuration details from Git and apply them to devices based on their group membership, thus making playbooks easily

variableized ([00:33:38](#)). Justin Rue noted they are already using dynamic inventory, which introduces complexities around variable merging and duplicate hosts in constructed inventories ([00:36:09](#)).

- **Host Duplication and Licensing Concerns:** Raed Soliman and Ramzi Husein addressed the concern regarding duplicate hosts appearing in constructed inventories, assuring the team that it does not affect the actual host count for automation targeting or licensing, although they acknowledged the visual annoyance ([00:37:03](#)). Ramzi Husein advised checking the AAP subscription page and host metrics to manage licensing anxiety and see how many hosts are actually being targeted for automation ([00:39:03](#)).
- **Subscription Status and Future Goals:** Justin Rue reviewed their host metrics, noting that their focus has been on DNS, Rancher, Big IPs, and the AAP nodes themselves ([00:41:09](#)). They confirmed that they have significantly more hosts imported (including non-traditional IT gear from Netbox) than hosts automated, and are nearing their node limit. They plan to move to a managed service to increase their license count, but need to continue showing value to justify the higher subscription ([00:42:14](#)) ([00:44:39](#)).
- **Project Refactoring and DNS Automation:** Justin Rue clarified that the team started fresh with a new GitLab project to align with corporate DevOps standards, meaning many playbooks and job templates from the previous Tower instance need to be refactored and migrated ([00:45:34](#)). They have existing, non-streamlined DNS deployment playbooks that handle service installation and configuration. They are also using the Netbox collection to add IPs and have created a use case for creating ServiceNow change requests from AAP ([00:46:53](#)).
- **Meeting Cadence and Future Engagement:** John Lorenz asked about the frequency of these Red Hat engagement meetings ([00:49:13](#)). Justin Rue confirmed the meetings have been recurring to ensure the automation journey progresses, and John Lorenz suggested greater and better engagement is needed, including bringing in more team members like Mandar and Stuart to enhance synergy and progress ([00:50:24](#)). Jason Anderson concluded by stating he would follow up on ideas for future conversations and the lab setup ([00:52:00](#)).
- **Future Workshop Discussion:** Justin Rue mentioned there has been previous interest in organizing a larger Red Hat workshop for the team to expand the automation audience, and they would like to pursue that opportunity ([00:53:09](#)). Ramzi Husein expressed interest in having an on-site presence in Orange County to help further the engagement .

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Transcript

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00:00:00

Jason Anderson: Um, Ramsey here is new. I'm going to ask him to introduce himself and then if you could give him a little bit of background about your environment and we can get into the conversation and the art of what's possible.

Justin Rue: Sounds good.

Ramzi Husein: All right, sounds good, Jason. So, my name is Ramsey Hussein. I am a Anible solution architect. Yeah, I heard you guys just want to get started doing network automation. So, Jason asked me to join, listen to what questions you have, and have a conversation.

Justin Rue: Yeah, we're we're definitely in the throws of network automation for sure. Um I I personally been focused on a lot of our F5 infrastructure. Uh we have a lot of load balancers um uh globally both physical and virtual. Um and so we we've been working with Panzible Automation Platform. Let me share my screen here. Do you see my screen? Okay. So um I've been working a lot on a lot of our big IT uh infrastructure.

00:01:17

Ramzi Husein: Yes.

Justin Rue: Um so as far as network automation, we've been working to basically um fasttrack uh new service delivery. Um one of those services being DNS. Um so we also have like DNS deployment playbooks that spin up new VMs, deploy DNS to them. uh at we can add them to the pools and the F5s and everything. It's not like not as streamlined as I would like it, but uh in fact we've started to kind of piece meal more out instead of one giant playbook. Um but we are working on um you know like workflow job templates um for example um to try and um get all those pieces together into one uh smooth process. Um uh so yeah, we've been working on we've got dynamic inventory um from a number of sources um most most recently Netbox uh which is intended to be kind of our configuration management database.

Ramzi Husein: Okay.

Justin Rue: Um all of our vscenter servers have got some um inventory inventory source in GitLab including the git the AAP nodes themselves. That's how we we built the environment, right?

00:02:44

Justin Rue: and uh um looking to maybe remove some of this if we can get more towards the net box side of things. Um so uh I have been working on uh the like the groups uh the group by filters in our netbox inventory. Um and you know we're obviously looking for um dynamic in dynamic grouping uh to leverage that dynamic inventory so that we can really uh streamline inventories but also some smart inventories that we're working on for all our big IP infrastructure so it's very clear to everyone um you know where the where the big IPs live and we have templates for not just provisioning but also um uh like uh get device info right get failover state you know registration information etc. So trying to just kind of um demystify our big IP infrastructure for everybody and then uh following up with the backend DNS infrastructure as well. And then um we have a lot of job templates that we had in tower that we really haven't even moved over in terms of um Linux operations um you know checks um um cir you know and a lot of custom in-house applications we'd like to try to automate against in the future as well.

00:04:08

Justin Rue: um looking for service now integration. I know netbox has a service now integration and we'd love to get into you know EDA and um we're we're we our understanding is that the barrier to entry on the on the service now and EDA uh integration has gone down and so we're trying to get that going. Um and we have uh custom execution environments that we've built and are have deployed um for use for the various use cases right if you want to interact with netbox there's a collection for that if you want to interact with the IP there's a collection for that etc so just trying to enable folks and um and and show value in the platform

Ramzi Husein: Okay. So, you're showing a bunch of big IP F5. Do you have other networking devices that are in Netbox or what kind of devices are in your CMDB there that you're trying to automate?

Justin Rue: We do we have a lot of Cisco Juniper um ground network equipment. Um we have a lot of um Linux systems,

Ramzi Husein: Mhm.

00:05:15

Justin Rue: some Windows systems. Um yeah, and we are pulling a lot of a lot of devices from um Netbox as well. We're pulling a lot of our SAT like infrastructure from Netbox because we are storing a lot of that Netbox in Netbox. Um we're not necessarily looking to automate against that right now with Anzipol, but I'm sure there has been some work on that in the past that I spearheaded um way back in the day. Um so that is something that if you know we can really unleash the beast from a licensing perspective, we can tackle those nodes. Um but uh that in that requires a lot of um interfacing with with other members of our team and um so we're focused

Ramzi Husein: right?

Justin Rue: on kind of our domain like F5 and DNS is very infrastructure related you know shared service almost um you know whereas a lot of the applications tend to be spread out across different customers and things like that.

Ramzi Husein: That makes sense. I think next step for you then would be okay, you have all the F5 stuff, you have your devices in here with dynamic inventory.

00:06:28

Ramzi Husein: Next step would be getting started with the EDA side of things and hooking that up with Netbox so that when you add a new device or change the config context on there, you automatically kick off jobs in AAP to apply those configs. Do you have any playbooks already or job templates for the Cisco devices or Juniper or you just done with F5 so

Justin Rue: We do um I haven't been working on as much. Um I have some colleagues actually I don't think Vincod is here um that's been working on a lot but we do have job templates from another single node. This is the multi-node. Um you know we're we're looking for redundancy. We're looking for scalability. So, where's the topology view? But this is our multi-node containerized 26. Um,

Ramzi Husein: Mhm.

Justin Rue: we do we did did have we do have a lab and um and like a single node instance where I know they've been doing a lot of the uh the Juniper stuff I believe. um and um looking to uh leverage bringing you know the APIs to bring those job templates maybe those inventories over as well.

00:07:38

Ramzi Husein: Gotcha. Okay.

Justin Rue: Absolutely.

Ramzi Husein: And the service now side of things, you you said you don't have that built out yet, but that's on your road map.

Justin Rue: Uh 100% Mauricio has been helping with that and um yeah we understand that it's now just like a token so we're trying to work with uh our corporate corporate IT department who runs a service now

Ramzi Husein: Great.

Justin Rue: platform. We have some other um irons in the fire with them in regards to that too. So we're we're working the time and trying to get

Ramzi Husein: Okay, let me go ahead and steal the screen here for a bit. Give me a second. Yeah, I just spun up like a Netbox lab so I can show you some of this stuff. Um, one second here.

Justin Rue: Matt, John. Uh, did I miss anything?

Ramzi Husein: What was that?

Justin Rue: I was just hitting up the pack folks like see if I glossed over anything in my ramble.

Ramzi Husein: Okay. Gotcha.

Matthew White: I think you're

00:08:56

John Lorenz: No,

Ramzi Husein: Okay.

John Lorenz: go ahead, Matt. Yeah.

Ramzi Husein: So I'd say next step kind of is to fill in the blanks with the actual Cisco and Juniper

John Lorenz: What do you think?

Ramzi Husein: playbooks like you were talking about and then going from there to like automatically launching it from Netbox. So for example, let's say you know I have this Netbox here. Make sure session we have like Netbox you know simple examples but okay I have a device in here cat one um I add like custom fields to it. So it knows how to work with Anible. So you give it like the host that it needs, the port, um then you create

like the web hooks themselves. So same thing like if you're doing with service now or any other tool um there's no custom EDA source like specific for Netbox. So what you do is you use the web hook EDA plugin, right? That we set up a web hook from Netbox to our AAP, right? But the idea is we use what's called a rule book.

00:09:57

Ramzi Husein: And from what I understand, Rad already talked about EDA with you guys, right? So you're familiar with what a rule book is, the sources and everything. Correct.

Justin Rue: Um, you know, we we've really not worked with them too much. Um, I I I we definitely could use some guidance in that

Ramzi Husein: Okay. Yeah,

Justin Rue: area.

Ramzi Husein: no worries. So basically, okay, you've been living here mostly in this automation execution section,

Justin Rue: Yeah. Yeah. We're absolutely and we you know we're we're containerizing that execution but absolutely we need to get

Ramzi Husein: right?

Justin Rue: into the automated decisions.

Ramzi Husein: Right. So basically a lot of it's analogous to the automation execution portion of it. Like you still have projects, right? But your projects would be the repos that have your rulebooks in them. You still have decision environments instead of execution environments. But same kind of thing. The difference here is that when you start a rulebook up, right, we create a rulebook activation instead of a job template and it stays running in the background listening.

00:10:54

Ramzi Husein: So you can see like the rules that are in the rule book, how many times it's fired off and you know if we click this, we see it's from this project. Let me just open that git repo and show you what it looks like. But what it's doing basically is you give it a source, right? So it looks like a playbook, but you give it a source. In this case, we're using the web hook source plugin. So here we're telling it, okay, listen on this host, open this port, or not open this port, listen on this port. And then instead of tasks, you give it a list of rules that it listens for. So in this case, we set up that web hook between Netbox

and AAP. And then once we activate this rulebook, it's going to start listening on that port for all the events that are coming in from that box. And in those payloads, it's going to look for conditions that you tell it to and then run specific actions uh based off of that.

00:11:51

Ramzi Husein: Right? So we have okay if we update the NTP config context on netbox and the um like basically if it's config context and NTP servers then we want to take the action or run a job template. This can also be like run workflow template or just a debug right whatever action you want to take there. Then we have one okay if a VLAN's created then go ahead and run the job template to configure that. if for instance a new device is added you know run workflow template instead just to provision the new device and do all of this stuff basically right so if we go back to here um rulebook activations that's what's happening here it's running in the background so now let's say I go to netbox I set up event rules in here for these different config contexts and the new devices right so I have one for login banner again simple examples But you can do whatever you want with it. Login, banner, NTP servers, and then one for a new device, right? So you can see these are the event types that the rulebook's listening for.

00:12:56

Ramzi Husein: If it's like config context, it's going to do something. If the name is NTP servers, it'll do something. New device, it'll do something different. Right now, if we go to the actual um config context themselves. Okay, so let me go to our AAP. Go to hosts. Same thing here. I'm using a dynamic inventory. All right. One device in here. You know, it's pulling this stuff in right now. Here's login banner source from Netbox. Here's the NTP servers. Right. So, if I go into the NTP servers, edit this. Let's say I remove one of these servers. Click save. What should happen is almost immediately through web hook like this will get updated, sent over to AAP. And you see the job is running already, right? So that basically if we go down to the rulebook activations, fire count went up. Rule audit will show you every single time it's been triggered. Right?

00:13:55

Ramzi Husein: So it didn't update yet, it looks like. So we'll just refresh this. There we go. So this one right here is the one that just ran. So you can click it and see. Okay, here's the event that came in. You can come in here and see the payload that came in and what it acted on. So you can see it saw two NTP servers in there, right? And you can see the action it took is to run this job template. We can click this. I guess cuz lab environment, I can't do that. So we have to go up here and click on it. But yeah, we can come up here and see. Okay, this is what ran. And you can see it went through and rendered it using a Ginga 2 template and basically applied the um NTP config right the two servers there. So that's one thing you can do. Other thing would be you know same exact thing with the login banner but let's say we're trying to add a new device.

00:14:47

Ramzi Husein: So we can go to our devices. Um let's say we want to add cat 2. It's a edge router. Cisco AKV. Let's put it AMIA Cisco.ios and give it host Cisco 2 port 22. We'll click create here. And now because we also have that rule set up to listen to new devices being created. If I go back to AAP, you can see it's can it's running the provision new device workflow. So now the rulebook saw that hey I got another event that came in. This time it's a new device added not just a config um context update and it went through our workflow to configure NTP and the banner according to the config context in there. And if we go over to our hosts now and see, let me go into the um second here. Go ahead and just uh sync this again.

Justin Rue: makes total sense and it's actually yeah that's awesome and it's like uh makes sense it's just a you

Ramzi Husein: Yeah.

Justin Rue: know web hooks between the two which is great you know on certain events and things like that um Anible is aware of the inventory um that

00:16:13

Ramzi Husein: Right.

Justin Rue: exists today because we're doing dynamic inventory from VMware but how how is netbox how does netbox get updated of what's in VM VMware can

Ramzi Husein: So I guess that's dependent

Justin Rue: Anible do that for us. Um, you know, I I know that there's some some effort on on there's some other efforts going on for dynamic discovery of certain devices. Um, but I'm, you know, I know that I know that Anzible knows, you know, about our our systems and and can certainly gather a lot of facts. So how how can we inject inject that into net fox or how how else do we achieve parody of like current state not just desired state but also current state um

Ramzi Husein: So are you saying like VMware is the source of truth then not Netbox? So you're not updating Netbox with your new devices. You're putting it in VMware and then pushing it to Netbox is what you're saying. Is that correct?

Justin Rue: Well, I mean, I think the dynamic state of things I I refer to VMware is like tectonic plates, right?

00:17:34

Justin Rue: It could shift underneath me ideally and it should be fine. But like how does Netbox know that that that now all of oral kind of knows

Ramzi Husein: Great.

Justin Rue: through the through the gathered facts and and VMware dynamic inventory, okay, this VM is in this host, right? But how does net how does netbox know that?

Ramzi Husein: Great.

Justin Rue: How does netbox know um if I if I want to deploy a new server to Hong Kong, how does it know which VMware VLANs are name are allow even exist in uh Hong Kong? And um and how does that translate to like the survey in the job template um that um that someone or

Ramzi Husein: Great.

Justin Rue: or Netbox I guess if you're going to provision like you're saying in Netbox, how do you select it in Netbox? But I also think about surveys and job templates and how to get those values in there too. So, you know, you know what I'm saying?

Ramzi Husein: Right.

Justin Rue: Like this is awesome and it's like but it's only one piece of the picture for us.

00:18:39

Justin Rue: I'm trying to figure out those other parts,

Ramzi Husein: Yeah, I hear you.

Justin Rue: if you will.

Ramzi Husein: So I guess in this case, Netbox is like that source of truth. So devices get added here. All the config contexts are in here under it, right? But if you have them in VMware and want to push it here through Anible, that's where you'd go to netbox um Anible collection. So, let's go look at this real

Justin Rue: Yeah,

Ramzi Husein: quick.

Justin Rue: we have a few rudimentary playbooks for that. I think um just for some basics. I don't think we've really dove dove into it and and really

Ramzi Husein: Right.

Justin Rue: taking like I said there's some other efforts um to to maybe look at dynamic um population and netox but I'm I'm certainly you know aware that that anible is so capable right and else.

Ramzi Husein: Right. No, I guess where I'm going with that is like so let's say we have the inventory from VMware go into AAP and you want to use AAP to push that to Netbox then use Netbox to push the config context to AAP to push it to devices.

00:19:41

Justin Rue: Yes.

Ramzi Husein: So basically you have the inventory in VMware that's where you can use for instance this like Netbox device module and have a playbook that'll go through the inventory basically and just create a new device for each of those hosts. Right? This is where you'd use the actual Netbox collection to change Netbox itself and not the devices. So you'd look for a module like this for instance, right? Where you can tell it, okay, go ahead and add this device and variableize this. So it's using information from the inventory itself that you're pulling from VMware, right? So it sounds like a multi-step thing where okay, you have that VMware dynamic inventory, then you you'd have a playbook that runs with this as an example, right? And we can look more into specific ways to do it. Um, this is just like spitballing right now, but you can use this to push the the device to Netbox. And in Netbox, you'd have those config contexts and basically have that EDA set up so that it um, basically configures the devices once they're in here.

00:20:47

Ramzi Husein: The other thing I'd need to look into is maybe it might make more sense to have that direct integration between VMware and Netbox and then have Netbox push

the config context to AP to launch those jobs if that makes sense. So something I'll look at take a look at offline after this call is does it make more sense for AAP to do that and keep the CMDB up to date or does it make more sense to integrate Netbox and VMware directly and then use AAP for the configuration. Right? So there's like multiple ways you can go with it if that makes

Justin Rue: I guess I just haven't been aware a aware of uh VMware integration.

Ramzi Husein: sense.

Justin Rue: I think some people who have been looking at box have been focused on other aspects of the

Ramzi Husein: Great.

Justin Rue: schema maybe um uh like uh like the racks and things like that. So, um, yeah, that's a that's a question for us. We're we're engaged with that box,

Ramzi Husein: Yeah.

Justin Rue: so we'll we'll we'll bring that

00:21:43

Ramzi Husein: But VMware is like the integration is very fleshed out as well.

Justin Rue: up.

Ramzi Husein: So there's a very very comprehensive like certified for it.

Justin Rue: That's funny. I haven't seen

Ramzi Husein: Oh, really? Let me show you it real quick.

Justin Rue: it.

Ramzi Husein: Um if we go to cloud.red.com. Have you played around with the um certified content yet? Taking a look at all that.

Justin Rue: I'm not sure what you're what you mean.

Ramzi Husein: Okay. So basically you get access to like this console.red.com red hat.com.

Justin Rue: Oh, cert you know big we're using the big IP module and that's the whole collection is certified,

Ramzi Husein: Yeah. Yeah.

Justin Rue: right? So that's why we've been working to peacemeal out a lot of our playbooks instead of having this

Ramzi Husein: Great.

Justin Rue: giant, you know, list of crazy tasks with multiple modules is if we stick to the if we keep a playbook small, just that one module or two and you know and and stick as close to the module docs

00:22:33

Ramzi Husein: Hey

Justin Rue: as possible, we could at least someday claim to have certified code, right?

Ramzi Husein: Right. That makes sense because again, you're not limited to using the certified content, but if it's there, you might as well, right? Because you can have it supported,

Justin Rue: Yep.

Ramzi Husein: open the tickets. You're just leaving stuff on the table if you're not doing that. Yeah. If we come in here, um, let's search for VMware real quick. So you can click here and see there's a few of them here, right? One is this one which is very fleshed out 134 modules. So I'd recommend using this one. You can come in here and see there's a ton you can do with VMware, right? So for instance in my lab environment, we have like service now running and if I can type my password right. Let me get my 2FA. I understand why 2FA is needed, but it's the pain of my

Justin Rue: I feel you.

Ramzi Husein: existence.

00:23:40

Justin Rue: The struggle's real.

Ramzi Husein: Yep. I'm sure you have to deal with all that,

Justin Rue: Oh, man.

Ramzi Husein: too.

Justin Rue: No, it's been crazy lately. Everything's a

Ramzi Husein: Yeah. All right. So for instance in service now we have it like built in the service catalog where okay we want to deploy a VM we can come in here and for instance give it like the tag we want the VM name we want um give it like the OS what hypervisor we want to deploy on and if we click order it basically launches it over in AAP like all this gets sent over to AAP and the job launches and now there's like an EDA plugin so you can do it with EDA as But either way, like it's like the service now integration to AAP is very fleshed out. Also VMware, right? So there's tons you can do there. Really, you just I mean the sky is like whatever you can imagine in that sense, right? Where okay, we have all these modules here we can use.

00:24:44

Ramzi Husein: um you just have to sit down and maybe like draft out here's the manual steps I'm doing today and then map those out one to one with the different modules and go from there if that makes sense.

Justin Rue: Definitely. And you know, we've been we've been so swamped. Um,

Ramzi Husein: Right.

Justin Rue: so a lot of that we've struggled to find the the cycles to to really put into it.

Ramzi Husein: Mhm.

Justin Rue: And also like we need to quantify that as well. And okay, what exactly needs to be done? and um get get that turned into a feature, right, John? Um anyway,

Ramzi Husein: So

Justin Rue: um yeah.

John Lorenz: No, I had to find the mute button. Sorry. Yeah, I I I think one Yeah, one of the things I'm sorry, I just uh got the job of uh managing this wonderful team here that

Ramzi Husein: Mhm.

John Lorenz: um one of the things I'm seeing is we just have to do better in planning out our projects and and tasks and and aligning this type of work where we can, you know, see it through and finish it.

00:25:55

John Lorenz: So that's uh where hopefully we'll get better here soon.

Ramzi Husein: I hear you. It's a It can be daunting. It's a lot of work, but like like you said,

John Lorenz: Yep. Yep.

Ramzi Husein: it's just splitting up to small tasks. Like you already have the execution part down. Now maybe next step is let's actually integrate netbox with it and make it so that when we change a config context it's actually pushing it to a device and then go from there and integrate VMware to that bring in service now. So yeah like you said it's just breaking it all down to pieces that you can actually put deadlines on and um work through that way. So I guess from there is there anything else I can do to help you from my side on this journey of yours or did I basically answer all your questions for today?

John Lorenz: Um, I have a question. Um, if Justin does. Um, so all the steps that you just went through,

Ramzi Husein: Yes.

John Lorenz: are is there like a um I hate to say it this way, is there like a procedure that can be followed until people are used to knowing where to go to look for everything?

00:26:58

John Lorenz: Like uh that kind of like maps out like if you want to do X, here's all the pl like what you just did. You just drove us through all the places we need to go, right? And where what we need to build. Is there already some sort of And I'm new,

Ramzi Husein: Yeah.

John Lorenz: so is there already some sort of place we can reference in case people forget and we want to, you know, that kind of

Ramzi Husein: Yeah. So, this lab here, I can spin it up for you.

John Lorenz: thing.

Ramzi Husein: I think I can only leave it open for like 48 hours or so. So if you give Jason or myself like some times you know you'll have available I can spin this up and all the instructions are in here. You see on the left, it can be like a classroom setting. So, it'll go through, tell you all the relevant ports,

John Lorenz: Yeah.

Ramzi Husein: all the different steps you have to take on the AAP side, Netbox side. Um, and you just tell me like how many seats you need.

00:27:43

Ramzi Husein: I can spin up some pods for you guys to have this and get that procedure down.

John Lorenz: Okay, cool. Yeah, very good. Yeah,

Ramzi Husein: And the Yeah,

John Lorenz: that that's No,

Ramzi Husein: go ahead.

John Lorenz: that's good for us, right? We do bounce around from project to project. So I can see that being a problem relearning things with before you're even super familiar with them and bouncing back and forth. So creating important ones that we're going to do um will probably be helpful right until we're until we're more good at it. If you were efficient,

Ramzi Husein: right now that makes sense. And all the repos used in the lab, they're

public. So once you're going through that lab, you you'll have access to these repos. So you can come and see the actual playbooks being used. Um you'll see like doing con like network config is fairly easy using like the Cisco um collection juniper collection like it's it's abstracted a lot. It's not it like going and typing the iOS commands on there.

00:28:41

Ramzi Husein: Everything is parameterized and super easy to use. So I think you'll like that when you go through it. But yeah has the playbooks being used, the rule books being used. Um so it'll be helpful to go through. So, I think that sounds like a good next step is getting you guys that lab so you can um actually get started with some of these things. Does that sound good to you guys?

Justin Rue: Sounds good to me. Um, yeah, absolutely. That that's great. And the repo access is great as well. You know, we're we're we are like John said, we're just bouncing around um and sometimes need a little help. So that that's

Ramzi Husein: Yeah, we're here for you. Right. You can see there's like three solution architects that ended up here. I didn't even know the other two were going to be on here, so I was surprised. But, um, yeah, you you're in good company. You have a lot of people in your corner ready to help you.

00:29:33

Ramzi Husein: And Jason will, um, drag us in, kicking and screaming if we need to help out.

Justin Rue: So so so Netbox has the git like the GitLab uh integration, right?

Ramzi Husein: Yeah.

Justin Rue: They can pull everything from GitLab and so can um Anible. So for a while I was thinking well then Git is the source of truth in some cases,

Ramzi Husein: Yeah,

Justin Rue: right?

Ramzi Husein: I'd say it is.

Justin Rue: And Yeah. So, um,

Ramzi Husein: Mhm.

Justin Rue: and I saw, uh, so, and I, and I pulled in my, you know, because we're using Anzible to deploy a new DNS server and using Anzible to generate the DNS configuration via Ginga templating, right? And I can pull those Ginga templates into

Netbox as config context. Um uh and I did that and I config context and then I can also

Ramzi Husein: Right.

Justin Rue: pull in my group varss that are in uh gitlab as uh uh well that's the config context right the the groups are the config context and the ginger template is the config template but what do I do after that like I

00:30:39

Ramzi Husein: Mhm.

Justin Rue: don't um what do I do with that like how do I get that assigned to something.

Ramzi Husein: Yeah.

Justin Rue: Uh, if you'll humor me if that's not asking too much.

Ramzi Husein: Yeah. So in this case we have like the config context. So you have that set up. So if we go to provisioning here, config context.

Justin Rue: Yeah.

Ramzi Husein: So let's see in here. I have it in my head. I'm trying to find where that tieup is. I might need to follow up with you on that part because I'm more versed in AAP side of things to be honest.

Justin Rue: Yeah.

Ramzi Husein: But like once you get that Yeah.

Justin Rue: So I'm trying So I'm trying to figure out how do So how would AP use that

Ramzi Husein: Go ahead. Oh, I see.

Justin Rue: instead of having to grab the bars from

Ramzi Husein: Right. So basically what you do is you set up this web hook. So it'll all be in that lab,

00:31:31

Justin Rue: G

Ramzi Husein: but yeah, you basically come in here under integrations, you set up that web hook. So you're going to give it the n your AAP node, the port, and if you remember in that rule book I had pulled up, this is the port we had that AAP is listening to um for web hooks. So you have that, right? That's the web hook integration. But then you create these event rules for every single one that you want sent over to AAP. Right? So if we click this, you can see like it's going to send over basically the um once that objects

updated, it's going to send over everything from the config context to AAP. Just something to be careful of is to also add the AP specific variables. So if we go back to our config context, you can see we have like custom fields added. Um where did it go? Under devices rather. So if you click this there's like these custom fields that AAP will use right to know okay let's connect on port 22 for SSH everything like that.

00:32:40

Ramzi Husein: But yeah I if I'm understanding the question correctly it's all done through the um like web hooks and event rules basically. And then you would go under the operations or admin side of the house and you generate this

Justin Rue: So,

Ramzi Husein: API token basically which is the part I glossed over. This might be where you're getting at too. You create an API token just like you would with um Yeah.

Justin Rue: Yeah,

Ramzi Husein: Go ahead.

Justin Rue: we got that. We got that.

Ramzi Husein: Oh,

Justin Rue: We we Yeah.

Ramzi Husein: you got

Justin Rue: Yeah, we're we're interacting with API a little bit,

Ramzi Husein: Okay.

Justin Rue: but just looking for additional use cases to like to take advantage, right? Um well,

Ramzi Husein: Yeah.

Justin Rue: yeah, that's that's good. Um that that's helpful.

Ramzi Husein: Of course,

Justin Rue: Thank you.

Ramzi Husein: the other way is like you can just have your like you said configuration as code in GitHub and skip the netbox part entirely. Like you can have your ansible playbooks just pull the config from your GitHub and use the Cisco modules, right?

00:33:38

Ramzi Husein: But where Netbox becomes helpful is if you're using it as a CMDB. Um so that way you update the CMDB AAP provisions everything keeps the CMDB in check.

But in this case, it sounds like you're using like three points here with like VMware, Netbox, and AAP. And then also have GitHub for the configuration like as a source of truth where in some cases it's helpful just going straight to AAP and having everything in GitHub as the variables if that makes sense.

Justin Rue: Did you you I didn't quite catch that. Like you're saying everything in in GitLab

Ramzi Husein: Yes. Yeah.

Justin Rue: again.

Ramzi Husein: So basically like okay let's say I um

Justin Rue: So did you would you just constitute the inventory in GitLab from VMware using Ansible like just put the inventory

Ramzi Husein: no I would still use it like wherever you have your CMDB you want that to be the source of truth for the inventory using the dynamic inventory source but then when it comes to configuration you can like you said keep it as group vss for instance let's they have like ales in here.

00:35:00

Ramzi Husein: I can set them up under group varss for my routers group. So now like if I pull this into AAP um I can use this variable inside of my playbooks to just apply this to everything in that group. So I could have one for like VLANs. I could have one for L3 interface config, L2 interface config. And that way when I run the actual playbooks the playbooks will look something like let me go to the roles here actually like that a one for instance right go in here to iOS you can see it's just going to take it as a variable and then the the module itself knows how to parse that and push it to the devices right so in that way you can use the gitlab repo as a source of truth truth. Have your configuration as code like I just showed you and then keep your playbooks basically variableized so it's not hardcoded, right? So that way you run the playbook, it knows from the VARS what to push to the specific devices depending on the group they're in. Does that make sense?

00:36:09

Justin Rue: Yep. Yeah. I Yeah, I love group bars. All right. You know, groups,

Ramzi Husein: Yeah.

Justin Rue: groups of groups, right? Child child groups and stuff like that. That's great.

Um,

Ramzi Husein: groups all the way down.

Justin Rue: so we were doing that, but we're also doing dynamic inventory.

Ramzi Husein: Yep.

Justin Rue: And so in AAP, I actually get um dupes and and like how those verb bars get merged is like a a big question,

Ramzi Husein: Gotcha.

Justin Rue: right? So like I kind of feel like I have to go one way or the other and not get stuck trying to do this merge on, you know? Um,

Ramzi Husein: Right. It's all like precedents. So there's a giant list of like variable precedents that's helpful to look at, but basically the more specific you get, the more precedents a variable has. So like host varss will override group varss.

Justin Rue: Sugar.

Ramzi Husein: Um extravss will override everything basically. So there's like a whole list of that that could come in handy there.

00:37:03

Ramzi Husein: Um yeah, the dupe thing. So you're saying you're having multiple devices or device show up multiple times in separate inventories, right? That shouldn't be an issue. um cuz it just gets counted as a node when it like targets that device. So it doesn't matter if it's being used in multiple places as long as you're using the same inventory name for it or like name for that device in your inventory.

Justin Rue: Okay.

Ramzi Husein: So I wouldn't worry too much about that,

Justin Rue: I guess I guess it's a little weird to see it show up twice in in in like a

Ramzi Husein: right?

Justin Rue: in like a constructed inventory or smart in in fact constructed inventories actually seem to produce extra hosts. like the host the host that the constructed inventory finds shows up more than once.

Ramzi Husein: I see it.

Justin Rue: Um and so I've actually pulled back on that and gone and I'm kind of using smart

Ramzi Husein: Right.

Justin Rue: inventory still um as a result. So any tips for that?

Ramzi Husein: Not at the top of my head.

00:38:04

Ramzi Husein: This is where I throw Rod and Devon under the bus and see if they have any tips for that. But no, that's something I can look into.

Raed Soliman: Yeah,

Ramzi Husein: Go

Raed Soliman: you it shouldn't really matter if it shows twice.

Ramzi Husein: ahead.

Raed Soliman: You're not being it's not being actually counted twice. So, if it's the same host in both inventories, it's it's it's it's it doesn't really affect you in any way,

Ramzi Husein: Right.

Raed Soliman: right?

Ramzi Husein: It's just annoying to look at.

Raed Soliman: Yeah. So like like the the the the the it's essentially the idea of think of it as like a stored query, right? So if something matches the query in multiple different constructed inventories, then it's going to go show in all of them. You see what I'm saying? So, is there a reason why you don't want it to show in one or you want it to show in one not in the other than the concern about being counted as a note?

Justin Rue: Well, I mean we are kind of in a in an interesting um you know we we we want a higher

00:39:03

Raed Soliman: Justin

Justin Rue: license uh count right license um so that we can hit more nodes. We really want to unleash the beast on the environment. So we are very licensed conscience. So I guess that just kind of triggered me a little bit. seeing that. Um, but that's good to know and I think we've I've heard that mentioned before, but I've always it's always been kind of uh interesting to look at as well as as Ramsey mentioned.

Ramzi Husein: Yeah. So,

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Ramzi Husein: I would say like if you go into your AP, one way to get rid of some of the anxiety is if you go to the um like where you're one second here, the actual subscription. And I would almost guarantee you have like less hosts automated than imported. So, you'll see like way more hosts remaining than the amount you have actually pulled into your AAP, right? All right. So, if you ever feel stressed out about that, you can come here and get like a sanity check and it'll show you how much are actually being used

00:40:08

Raed Soliman: Yeah. And show them the host metrics page while you add it.

Ramzi Husein: there.

Raed Soliman: Scroll up because that that would show them like the breakdown of how many times each host has been touched. Yeah. So,

Ramzi Husein: Yeah,

Raed Soliman: uh this in the like it's very empty in this page, but in your environment.

Ramzi Husein: I could pull up a different one.

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Ramzi Husein: Yeah.

Raed Soliman: Thanks.

Ramzi Husein: You love Shadowman, don't you? Go in here. Um, host metrics. Yeah. So, you can see like it brings up a lot of your metrics here basically. So, it show you all the host names, um, how much times they've been like soft deleted, how much times they've been targeted for automation, and you can also see like how close you are to your compliance as well. Right. So, if you haven't played around with automation analytics, it's kind of cool. You come in here and see, you know, how much savings you have. Um, you know, like we're saving \$2 million here somehow.

00:41:09

Ramzi Husein: And you can see all the metrics and everything. So, that combined with the subscription page down here should help manage some of that anxiety around licensing for sure. Yeah. Anything else I can help you guys out with,

Justin Rue: I was I was I was just looking I was just looking at it on ours.

Ramzi Husein: Justin? Okay. Yeah,

Justin Rue: I could share for the uh for the for the benefit

Ramzi Husein: go for

Justin Rue: 13 here.

Ramzi Husein: it.

Justin Rue: I am getting an error on the uh automation calculator which is weird. Don't know what that's

Raed Soliman: No, in order for it to work,

Justin Rue: for.

Raed Soliman: you'll have to enable something in settings so that they can upload information and pull it from the portal. It's not like a fully offline thing. So, the error is uh expected.

Justin Rue: Okay.

Raed Soliman: It's It's worth it.

Justin Rue: Yeah, this is this is insightful, right? You can see kind of where our focus has been. Um, you know, DNS as I mentioned, some rancher nodes we've we've hit and then a bunch of big IPs, uh, and the AP nodes themselves.

00:42:14

Justin Rue: So um yeah we really want to and you can see you know in our account there's a you can see my screen

Ramzi Husein: Yeah, we can see

Justin Rue: right okay yeah cool so we have quite a few nodes because we

Ramzi Husein: it.

Justin Rue: are I don't know if you missed this John earlier but we are pulling quite a few nodes in from netbox including um like uh sat gear um enclosures and things

John Lorenz: Yeah, I don't know. I don't know how that I don't know how that works.

Justin Rue: like

John Lorenz: And maybe you can explain it to me later. Um,

Justin Rue: we can we can pull them out, John. But I mean, in the past, you know,

John Lorenz: but

Justin Rue: um we did the for the upgrades, we did uh the bunny checklist with where they we helped, you know, automate a lot of the commands run on some of the hub module gateways and stuff like that. So maybe one day, but we, you know, we do need to work, we can work on the um the netbox um source filter and just kind of focus on other stuff.

00:43:18

Justin Rue: Um so I've been I've been working on

John Lorenz: Okay. All right. Maybe you can walk me through that later.

Justin Rue: that

John Lorenz: I I am interested to understand because um I I I think it kind of is important to what we want to do long term. So I just want to be a understand it better.

Justin Rue: Yeah, here here's the here's the uh inventory right here. Um, so I just recently updated the group by variables to try because we were having a bit of group sprawl. So we're trying to limit it to just roll because device type was a bit verbose. Um, and then, um, we can also do, um, I don't have the docs up, but, uh, if I look up the NB inventory docs, um, there's some group B, some uh, query filters that we can throw in there, John, and we can we can focus on what we care about, nothing we don't, right? Um, you talked about the subscription and I think we actually

Ramzi Husein: right?

Justin Rue: do have a lot more hosts imported than we do hosts automated.

00:44:39

Ramzi Husein: Yeah,

Justin Rue: And you can see I only have a few hosts remaining and Yeah.

Ramzi Husein: it looks like you definitely need some more nodes. So, if you're going to touch all 4,000 of those.

Justin Rue: And my Yeah.

Ramzi Husein: Yeah, you're only at 100 right now.

Justin Rue: Yep.

Ramzi Husein: Okay.

Justin Rue: Yep. And yeah,

Ramzi Husein: Are there plans to increase that soon as Okay,

Justin Rue: there's plans to go to like the manage service.

Ramzi Husein: gotcha.

Justin Rue: Um, and we've been talking about a higher license count there,

Ramzi Husein: Okay,

Justin Rue: but I do think that we we still need to prioritize. Um,

Ramzi Husein: great.

Justin Rue: and uh, yeah, I would like to show value and then just, you know,

Ramzi Husein: Mhm.

Justin Rue: if we could do that, we can, you know, certainly justify a higher subscription.

Ramzi Husein: Right. It sounds like there's a plan now, right? So, we got to get that EDA working with Netbox, start automating some of that config context being pushed to devices. I think that'll help help you show some value there for sure because right now you have all that big IP stuff that's already showing a lot of value for the um F5 devices.

00:45:34

Justin Rue: Yep.

Ramzi Husein: And that looks super fleshed out. See if Yeah, you have a ton in there for that.

Justin Rue: Yeah. Um, let's see. Our old tower,

Ramzi Husein: So,

Justin Rue: we had a lot for the DNS as well. Um, see if I can get into there.

Ramzi Husein: Oh, so you still haven't moved everything over from tower to this yet. So,

Justin Rue: We kind of we kind of we kind of started fresh,

Ramzi Husein: there's even more.

Justin Rue: you know.

Ramzi Husein: Yeah.

Justin Rue: We we um we we there was a there was an effort uh to create a new GitLab project that aligned with our um DevOp teams uh DevOps our corporate DevOps teams uh GitLab standards. The original project was kind of just haphazard and so we took that as an initiative to standardize a bit more um just go across the board. So, um, that's what we were working on. And, uh, yeah, a lot of the job templates and, um, playbooks in the old tower and that old repo, we still plan to bring some of those over, um, and just to, you know, refactor and make sure it's all super streamlined.

00:46:53

Ramzi Husein: Gotcha. Okay, that makes sense.

Justin Rue: Um yeah, for DNS we have um lots of different inventories, but we also have let's see, I got some DNS uh playbooks as well. So um we have the DNS deployment on the D IP on the big IP, but we also have uh like a DNS deployment workflow. Um oh, maybe not that one. Um that's the multi-orbit one. This so this was just kind of one big playbook though. Uh but this you know does the

Ramzi Husein: Mhm.

Justin Rue: uh DNS service deployment the actual install bind install onbound and configure them and all that. Um so yeah and uh yeah we have a lot of other applications we'd like to bring on

Ramzi Husein: Right.

Justin Rue: Lena and you know bring the reins in on um but I mentioned earlier we have some some net box playbooks um right adding IPs

Ramzi Husein: Mhm.

Justin Rue: and things like that but uh we we want to add additional use cases here for

Ramzi Husein: Okay,

Justin Rue: sure.

Ramzi Husein: cool.

00:48:15

Ramzi Husein: So, you're already using the collection. That's good to see.

Justin Rue: Yep. Yep.

Ramzi Husein: Cool.

Justin Rue: Uh and uh we were look we you know there's some people were saying oh we'll just use the module for the inventory but I I definitely wanted to get the inventory plugin working.

Ramzi Husein: Mhm.

Justin Rue: Um so we did

Ramzi Husein: Yeah. I mean, that's the way to go, right? Because now you can just hit sync and it make sure it matches it.

Justin Rue: that.

Ramzi Husein: So, I think that's a right move there for sure.

Justin Rue: Oh, we also have a service now change request like so you can actually create a service now change request from here.

Ramzi Husein: Right.

Justin Rue: Um and yeah few other use cases.

Ramzi Husein: So, you just need the other way around now.

Justin Rue: Yeah exactly 100%.

Ramzi Husein: Cool. But yeah, that's really where AP shines when it comes to Service Now is that birectional communication because yeah, you can update the tickets but then also have everything get kicked off from Service Now, which I'm sure you've seen.

00:49:13

Ramzi Husein: It sounds

Justin Rue: Yeah,

Ramzi Husein: like

Justin Rue: we did see a demo in that. It was Yeah,

Ramzi Husein: cool. Anything else I can help you out you all out with?

Justin Rue: I think I'm good. Um, any question? Any other questions from the pack

team? Well, we got the red hat team here on Anzible or

John Lorenz: Hey Justin. Um,

Justin Rue: AP

John Lorenz: I don't have any. Um, how often are we doing these? Is this like a monthly, weekly type thing or is this a one-off that you set up when we need like cuz we're going to do the lab setup next? Right. So, I'm just trying to gauge that.

Justin Rue: We've been pretty engaged with Red Hat uh John. We've been doing this every so often um but not necessarily with all the same folks or um you know solutions architecture architects on the call but we are we have been trying to touch base and make sure that the automation journey for pack just continues to move forward.

00:50:24

Justin Rue: for trying to help us gain velocity as you know we got to do a lot more with less.

John Lorenz: So,

Justin Rue: So

John Lorenz: these are add as needed meetings.

Justin Rue: uh

John Lorenz: Okay. I wasn't sure if it was a reoccur. That That's kind of what I was trying to

Justin Rue: it for me it has been going on recurringly so for a while now

John Lorenz: understand.

Justin Rue: and um I think Richard didn't have it and I have and I have a few calls.

John Lorenz: Yeah. Because what I'm seeing is right, we want to get that lab set up and get the routine going. It looks like we might need some help for that. So, I suspect we'll have some followup to this, right? And and that's what I'm seeing at the

Justin Rue: Yeah. And I think we need greater and better engagement,

John Lorenz: moment.

Justin Rue: John. We, you know, this this tool is intended for many people to use, I think.

John Lorenz: Yeah. Yeah.

00:51:10

John Lorenz: We probably want to pull in Bandar um Stewart and a few others that are

going to be also important

Justin Rue: can.

John Lorenz: to um the full scale automation that we want to put in place. Um so

Justin Rue: Yeah, I was talking to Mandar about that about that,

John Lorenz: yeah.

Justin Rue: you know, those enclosures like he's like, "You don't need those." And I was like, "Okay, we'll talk about the filters for sure.

John Lorenz: Yeah. Yeah. Because I think one of the biggest things as we talked about, we need to get everybody on the same page on how we're going to be doing things going forward. So, probably having that automation group of people start to participate and be together uh will help the synergy and get us all on the same page and then we can actually make some progress too as part of that.

Justin Rue: Yeah. Yeah.

John Lorenz: So

Justin Rue: I know Christine's been helping me a long time for with um with uh Anzible and um to like she helped me rent tower for a long time and like so she's a great resource

00:52:00

John Lorenz: yeah,

Justin Rue: and that as well you know just and I did invite some other people but um I guess not everybody can make it today but uh and we are looking to really spread the message John um that you have tool you have you have tools

John Lorenz: yep.

Justin Rue: that can do things for you now right we don't have to achieve these things the way we have in the past.

John Lorenz: Yep. Okay. Yep. Sounds good.

Jason Anderson: All right, then. Um, Justin, I will follow up with you in a couple weeks on uh or probably next week on ideas uh for our next conversations and thoughts um as well. Just ping me, let me know when you want those labs set up and we can get that going for you. Um but if there's anything else we can do, please please feel free to reach out.

Ramzi Husein: Yep. Thanks for your time, gentlemen. Hope you learned

Justin Rue: Yeah, absolutely. I think there's been talk about a a work maybe getting a Red Hat workshop together for pack.

00:53:09

Ramzi Husein: something.

Justin Rue: Um I'd like to I know uh Jake has some had some appetite for for that in the past and we keep losing momentum on it. on. But uh we definitely like to pick that up.

John Lorenz: All

Justin Rue: Thanks guys. Uh Richard,

John Lorenz: right.

Justin Rue: let me know about that. Uh if we ever get another shot at having you guys uh do like a like a larger general like automation presentation for like a really we just need to expand the audience. tomorrow and get them onesie twzies here and um you know think if we could maybe get some presents on site meet and um I know I missed you that one time but uh maybe another time. Anyway, thanks guys.

Ramzi Husein: Thank you.

Justin Rue: All right,

Ramzi Husein: Thanks, Jess. Wait,

Justin Rue: bye.

Ramzi Husein: are you in um LA or where are you located?

Justin Rue: We're in Orange County. We're in Orange County.

Ramzi Husein: Orange County.

Justin Rue: Where you Where are you guys?

Ramzi Husein: I'm in North Carolina. We're kind of spread out.

Justin Rue: Yeah.

Ramzi Husein: I think I'm the only one in North Carolina. Um,

Justin Rue: Yeah.

Ramzi Husein: yeah. I mean, I wouldn't mind coming out to you guys there in uh or sunny Orange County. See, I'll talk to Justin. I mean, Jason about that. You're Justin.

Justin Rue: Just just just do another just do another summit connect or or just Yeah.

Ramzi Husein: Yeah.

Justin Rue: Come see us.

Ramzi Husein: Right.

Justin Rue: That'd be great.

Ramzi Husein: We'll find an excuse to be out there. All right. It was nice meeting y'all.

Justin Rue: Sounds good.

Ramzi Husein: Yep.

Jason Anderson: Nice.

Justin Rue: Thank you.

Ramzi Husein: Happy Friday. See you.

Justin Rue: See you.

Transcription ended after 00:58:59

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